A WATERDEEP & UNDERMOUNTAIN CAMPAIGN

THE ECHO BELOW

A home above. A mystery below.

PLAYER GUIDE

ILLUSTRATED CAMPAIGN EDITION

At the table

A guide to the people, places, and shared expectations that begin your adventure. The campaign belongs to the choices you make together.

This edition is intended for players. Your Dungeon Master reveals discoveries, maps, and character details as they become known in play.

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Your campaign begins

A player guide

You begin near Phandalin with a job to escort supplies and help Gundren Rockseeker. The first part of the campaign is a classic adventure of missing friends, dangerous roads, a troubled town, and a lost mine.

Later, Waterdeep becomes home. The Yawning Portal is a place to rest, tell stories, find work, and descend into the vast dungeon beneath the city. The campaign will move between city life, Undermountain, and journeys to unusual places beyond Waterdeep.



A glimpse of the campaign

The tone

This is a story about friendship, discovery, difficult choices, and the people affected by powerful magic. You can expect mystery, exploration, occasional danger, rival adventurers, and a home base full of recurring faces. Your choices matter; curiosity is welcome, and caution is never punished for its own sake.

You do not need to know Waterdeep, Forgotten Realms lore, or a published adventure. Ask questions, make plans, and tell the group what your character cares about.

Make a character who has something to protect

Bring one answer to each question:

- Who would you return to if you could?
- What kind of injustice makes you unable to walk away?
- What object, secret, promise, or reputation tempts you?
- What is one place you hope to see?

Your answer can change during play. The campaign has room for your backstory rather than requiring you to solve a prewritten personal mystery.

Your current party

Trista is a Human Monk with a sharp eye for hidden value and a real instinct to help people who have less power. Gundren Rockseeker trusted her when she needed a second chance.

Donavan Kemp is a Human Wizard / Cleric and field researcher from the Kemp Archive and Arcane University in an elven metropolis. He travels with a barn owl familiar, a staff, a crowded satchel, and a habit of writing down what others might overlook. He wants to understand the multiverse, including the Fey Realm, and use knowledge to expose abuse rather than hide it.

Ringgo Paul is a Tiefling Rogue and former assassin from Baldur's Gate who is trying to leave the criminal world behind. He is a gifted scout, infiltrator, and survivor. The campaign will test whether he can use dangerous skills to protect people without letting old habits decide who he remains.

Byron plays Pebble, a level-3 Goron Champion fighter seeking a shiny rock he hopes will taste wonderful. Curious about new places but afraid of getting lost, he values his traveling companions. Bowman plays Aldric Vane, a level-3 Reborn Evocation wizard with a Haunted One past. His history is his to share during play. Trista is a level-3 Warrior of Shadow monk, Donavan a level-3 Wizard 2 / Cleric 1, and Ringgo a level-3 Assassin rogue.

All five characters take part in this campaign. Dracuseth remains in Waterdeep as an NPC contact.

Where you left off

You learned that the Black Spider exists and that the Redbrands have Gundren. You cleared the orc camp. At Old Owl Well, Hamun Kost disappeared rather than fight. Play stopped just before you entered the Redbrand hideout. Decide your approach together when play resumes. The details of what lies inside remain to be discovered.

Your character sheets

The live character sheets are the source of truth for mechanics. Trista currently uses the 2024 Monk rules. Ringgo's sheet uses legacy rogue and tiefling features; the Nick and Vex labels on his weapons do not apply unless the DM explicitly grants Weapon Mastery. Donavan follows the rules printed on his live sheet. Donavan and Aldric may use all listed spells under the approved table rule; their normal slot limits still apply. Ringgo has Stealth and Investigation Expertise. Use the current level-3 handouts, rather than historical Session 1 or Level 2 editions.

Trista, Donavan, and Ringgo already have reasons to trust Gundren's work. Pebble joined to reach the mines with company; Aldric decides what to share about his reasons for joining. Let the five characters' choices about a missing friend and a dangerous mine reveal why they become a party.

At the table

The group can approach danger through conversation, stealth, travel plans, research, combat, or retreat. A failed roll changes the situation instead of erasing the adventure. Tell the DM what you are trying to do and what you hope to protect; you are never required to make a particular story choice because of a flaw or background.

The feeling of Waterdeep

Think rain on slate roofs, lanterns in old windows, crowded bookshops, harbor fog, warm meals after a hard journey, and an impossibly deep well in the center of a famous inn. The city will remember your choices.